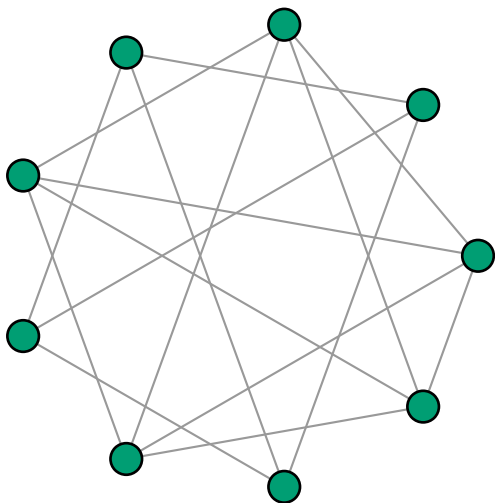
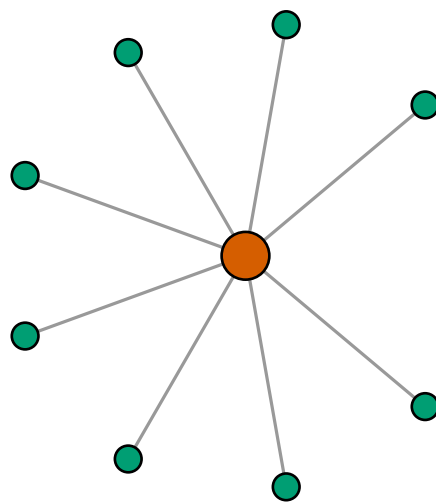


Predicted Topological Evolution of the Lightning Network (Fig. 7)  
CONCEPTUAL SCHEMATIC, not a simulation or measurement

**Early Stage: Mesh-Like**



**Mature Stage: Hub-and-Spoke**



Hub (liquidity-concentrated node)